

Turning one LinkedIn connection into Fluidstack's network lead

Account entry plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: HubSpot, Lemlist, ZoomInfo, Apollo

\$5B Pentagon loan in talks (Sep 11)	\$1.5B round at \$18B, led by Jane Street (Sep)	24 Fluidstack leads in Wave C	1 LinkedIn connection (Nate Sellers)
STAGE Wave C prospect. No deal.	RUNNING NOW CTF ABM - Fluidstack (Wave C), 24 leads (22 added Sep 28)	LAST TOUCH Sep 30: LinkedIn DM to Nate Sellers offering a Chicago ring map	NEXT STEP Fri Oct 2: trim the list to 5; Mon Oct 5: email Brian Arndt (Network Lead)

Bottom line

Fluidstack is building data centers for frontier AI labs (a reported **\$50B program for Anthropic**), is in **talks for a \$5B Pentagon loan** (Sep 11), and raised \$1.5B at an \$18B valuation in a round led by Jane Street. It's hiring switchgear and network operations engineers and moved its HQ to New York. Your Wave C list has grown to **24 people**, mostly network-operations leads added Sep 28. That's too wide: twenty-plus people at one company getting the same email looks like spray-and-pray. One person engaged: **Nate Sellers (Staff Network Engineer)** accepted on LinkedIn Sep 19. The plan cuts the list to five, keeps Sellers warm, and goes to **Brian Arndt, Network Lead** (joined Aug 2026 from Oracle data center leadership).

What Fluidstack is, in one analogy

Fluidstack is a general contractor that builds and runs custom factories for a few very large tenants. When a tenant signs, the contractor has months to wire the site. Being the known fiber option before the contract is signed is the whole game.

Signals worth citing

Signal	Source	So what for the opener
Pentagon in talks to lend ~\$5B to Fluidstack (Sep 11)	ZoomInfo news	Government-scale build-out. Security and diversity requirements will be strict.
\$1.5B round at \$18B valuation led by Jane Street (Sep 5-6); Data Center intent 91 (Sep 12)	ZoomInfo scoop, intent	Funded and actively researching data centers.
Hiring Principal Operations Engineer, Network (Puerto Rico), Director of Manufacturing (Phoenix), electrical chief engineers (Austin, CA)	ZoomInfo scoops	Many sites in flight. Ask about the Midwest.
Brian Arndt joined as Network Lead (Aug 2026), ex-Oracle Senior Data Center Lead, ex-AWS	Apollo	New owner; building his vendor list.
HQ relocated to New York (Dec 2025); TeraWulf and Hut 8 data center deals (Dec 2025)	ZoomInfo news	Context for scale.

Check first

24 contacts at one company in one sequence will hurt deliverability and reputation. Remove all but five (Sellers, Sulek, Arndt, Wells, one DC architect) before Monday.

Work already in motion

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Sep 11-14	Wave C, email 1	To Nate Sellers and Lukasz Sulek	No replies
Sep 19	LinkedIn	Nate Sellers accepted the invite	1 connection
Sep 21	LinkedIn DM	Conduit vs carrier attestation question to Sellers	No reply
Sep 24	Email	'What the diversity math looks like for a GPU cluster' to Sellers; email 2 to Sulek	No replies

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Sep 28-30	Wave C, 22 new leads	Network ops leads, DC architects, DC construction director added; most step 1 skipped	List too wide
Sep 30	LinkedIn DM	Offered Sellers a map of the Chicago ring against Fluidstack's sites	No reply yet

Who to reach, in order

Contact	Title (source)	Where	Why they matter	Status / email
Brian Arndt	Network Lead since Aug 2026 (Apollo). Ex-Oracle DC lead, ex-AWS.	New York	New owner of network.	Not contacted; email unavailable. Find via ZoomInfo
Nate Sellers	Staff Network Engineer (HubSpot)	Florida (863)	Connected; warmest door.	LinkedIn connected; 2 DMs, no reply
Lukasz Sulek	Staff Network Engineer (HubSpot)	Washington (425)	Peer of Sellers.	Wave C, 2 emails
Andrew Wells	Director, Data Center Preconstruction & Construction (HubSpot)	Texas (832)	Knows where the next sites are.	Email 1 Sep 29
Jason Kichen	CISO (HubSpot)	n/a	Pentagon deal makes security relevant; not a buyer.	In catch-all list. Hold

Not worth chasing for this goal

Remove the network-operations leads, technicians, sourcing manager and automation engineers added Sep 28 from the sequence; they won't decide fiber and the volume risks spam complaints.

How the access path should run



Messages, by contact

1. Nate Sellers Staff Network Engineer

Why them: Connected; ask for a name, not a meeting.

Channel: LinkedIn DM **Mon Oct 5 | Subject:** n/a

Nate, last one from me. Is Brian Arndt the right person for metro fiber decisions now, or someone else? A name is all I need, and thanks for connecting.

2. Brian Arndt Network Lead

Why them: New owner; Oracle and AWS data center background.

Channel: Email (once found) **Wed Oct 7 | Subject:** A Chicago option for your fiber bench

Brian, congrats on the new role. As Fluidstack's sites multiply, I'd like Crosstown to be a known option for diverse metro fiber in Chicago, where we own underground routes on-net at 350 E Cermak and Elk Grove. Worth 15 minutes, or should I send a map for your files?

The plan

When	Move	Notes
Fri Oct 2	Remove 19 of the 24 Fluidstack leads from Wave C.	Protect deliverability.
Mon Oct 5	LinkedIn DM to Sellers; find Arndt's email via ZoomInfo.	-
Wed Oct 7	Email Brian Arndt.	-
Mon Oct 12	Email Andrew Wells: any Midwest sites in the pipeline?	-
Week of Oct 26	Goal: 15-minute intro with Arndt.	-

What progress looks like (for management)

By	Milestone	How we will know
Oct 9	List trimmed to 5; Arndt contacted	Lemlist and HubSpot
Oct 30	Reply from Arndt or Sellers	Logged

Guardrails

- Never more than five people per account in one sequence.
- Credits used: 1 Apollo person enrichment; ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company.

Sources

Lemlist 'CTF ABM - Fluidstack (Wave C)' including Nate Sellers LinkedIn activity; HubSpot contacts; ZoomInfo news (Dec 2025 - Sep 14, 2026), scoops (Sep 5-24) and intent (Sep 12); Apollo people data (Oct 1, 2026).